Rhythms of Day and Night

Day and night follow each other in a rhythmic way. Most animals and plants are active during the day and sleep at night. Some plants close their leaves by evening, e.g., Rain tree (Thoongu-Moonji Maram). However, some animals are active at night. The bat, owl, wild big cat, mouse, wolf, cockroach and firefly are examples of animals that are active at night.

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Bat



Owl



Mouse



Wild Cat



Wolf



Cockroach



Firefly

They are active at night to:

- Catch other animals wandering at night for their food
- Avoid animals that eat them during the day
- Avoid the heat of the day

They have:

- Big eyes (owl, cat)
- A sharp sense of smell (mouse, dog)
- Good hearing (bat)

DO YOU KNOW?

Bats use sound waves to fly and hunt. Owls can see what is behind them by rotating their heads almost fully.



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